

saves the piece, but after 15 Bxd7 Qxd7 16 Na3 h6! Black's next move will be Qxh3 with very strong play on the light squares.

3) He can defend his bishop with 15 Na7. Most of White's efforts have concentrated around this move. The variations are complicated but the fact is that after 15...Nb8! the white knight will not return from its foray deep into enemy territory. For example, 16 Nxc8 Rxc6 17 Na7 Rb6! or 16 Bg2 Bb7 17 a4 Bxg2 18 Kxg2 c6 and in both cases it is only a matter of time before Black regains the piece with, at least, an equal game.

4) Arkell chooses another method. He doesn't try and save the piece but returns it in order to take the game into a favourable endgame.

15 Nxd4! Nb8!

Now White has two pieces attacked and must lose one of them.

16 Nde6! Qxd1 17 Rxd1 Bxe6 18 Nxe6 fxe6 19 Be4!

The first new move but it wouldn't surprise me if Arkell had already played this in previous unpublished games. A previous game, Salov-A. Kuzmin, USSR 1981, had concluded 19 Bg2 Bxb2 20 Rb1 Bd4! 21 Be3 Bxe3 22 fxe3 Nd7 23 Rxb6 Draw agreed.

19...Bxb2 20 Rb1 Bxc1 21 Rbxc1 (Diagram 21)

The difference with the game above is that Black can no longer play 20... Bd4 as the white rook on b1 is defended. White now has a clear advantage in the endgame. The remaining moves were:

21...Na6 22 Rd2 Rfb8 23 Kf1 Rd6 24 Re2 c5 25 Rc3 Rbb6 26 Bd3 Nb4 27 Bc4 Kf7 28 Rce3 Kf6 29 Rf3+ Kg7 30 Rfe3 Kf6 31 a4 Nd5 32 Rf3+ Kg7 33 a5 Rb7 34 a6 Ra7 35 h4 h5 36 Re5 Nb6 37 Bxe6 Rxa6 38 Rf7+ Kh6 39 Rxe7 c4 40 Rc5 Ra1+ 41 Kg2 Re1 42 Rcc7! Rd7! 43 Rxd7 Nxd7 44 Bxd7 Re7 45 f4! c3 46 f5! Kh7 47 f6 Rf7 48 Kf3? Rxf6+ 49 Ke2 Rf7 50 Kd1 Kh6 51 Kc2 Rf3? 52 Rxc3 Rf7 53 Bc8 Rf6 54 Kd2 g5 55 hxg5+ Kxg5 56 Rc5+ Kg6 57 Ke3 h4 58 g4 h3 59 Rh5 Rb6 60 Bf5+ Kg7 61 Rxh3 Rb3+ 62 Bd3 Black resigns

Summary

1) The Gallagher variation is a very sharp line which is based as much upon psychology as anything else. The players who play this line with White like to feel they are in control of the situation. They don't mind complications, but in their own time after they have built up their position first. They are not especially fond of the chaos that can arrive from the word go in this variation.

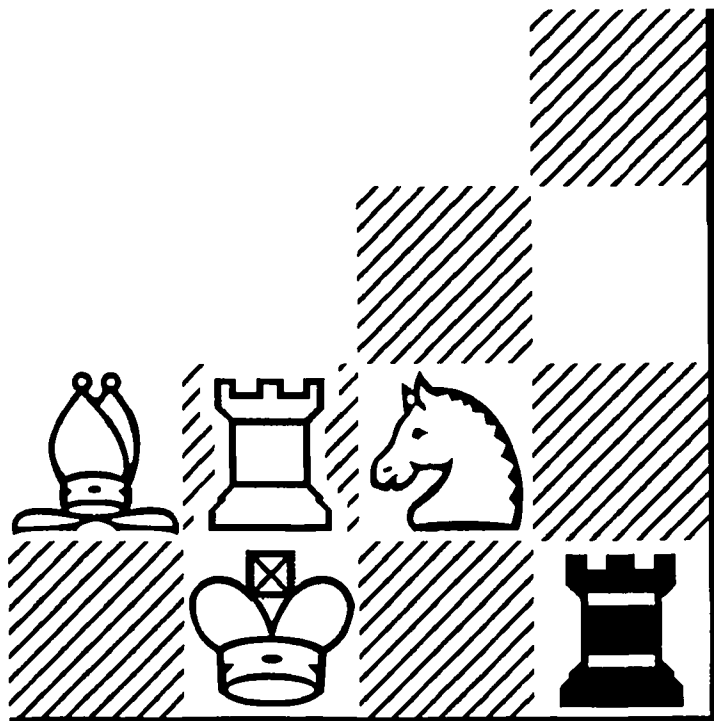
2) 8...a6 has become a very respectable line. At the moment it looks like one of the best ways for Black to play against the Fianchetto.

3) The Panno Variation can also lead to extremely complex double-edged games after both 8 d5 and 8 h3. Theoretically speaking, Black is struggling to prove equality.

Chapter Seven

The Four Pawns Attack

- 6...c5: The Main Line 7 d5 e6 8 Be2 exd5 9 cxd5
- 6...c5: Early Deviations
- The Modern 6...Na6



1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f4 0-0 6 Nf3 (Diagram 1)

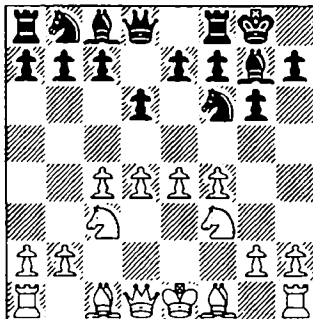


Diagram 1
The Four Pawns Attack

The Four Pawns Attack is the most aggressive way for White to meet the King's Indian. It is a truly dangerous system for the unprepared player to face. By the fifth move White has constructed a massive centre with the simple intention of blowing Black away. He will hope to achieve this by advancing e4-e5 at the right moment. If you had a centre like this a hundred years ago then it was assumed that victory was only a matter of time. Since then chess has moved on and strategies have been devised for combating such centres

What are the methods of combating such a centre?

Black must counter in the centre straightaway. While White has been moving pawns Black has been moving pieces and acquired a small lead in development. Black must try and open the position before White has consolidated. If he succeeds, then the drawbacks to White's risky strategy may become apparent. By moving all his central pawns forward he has weakened a whole group of squares behind the centre. If the centre can be liquidated then Black may well be able to establish advanced outposts on squares such as e3 or d3. But that is a long way in the future and a big 'if'. The Four Pawns Attack is a respectable variation that has evolved over the decades. The centre cannot be destroyed so easily. The point is, though, that if Black doesn't try he is likely to be heading to the showers around move 20.

In the King's Indian Black usually counters in the centre by ...e7-e5 or ...c7-c5. In the Four Pawns Attack Black has traditionally played ...c7-c5 as it was thought too difficult for him to arrange ...e7-e5. Whilst 6...c5 is still the main line and the subject of our first two subsections, a new method for Black based on 6...Na6 followed by ...e7-e5 has emerged in recent times. This is the subject of our third subsection

6...c5: The Main Line 7 d5 e6 8 Be2 exd5 9 cxd5

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f4 0-0 6 Nf3 c5 7 d5 e6 8 Be2 exd5 9 cxd5 (Diagram 2)

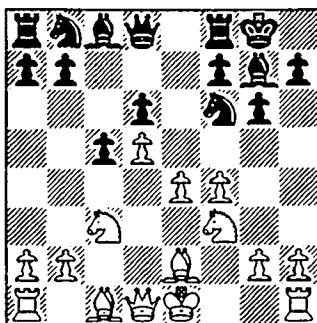


Diagram 2
A typical Four Pawns position

The moves leading up to this position will be examined in the next sub-section. Here we shall start our coverage with Black's 9th move. He has three options. The solid 9...Bg4, the sensible but risky 9...Re8 and the wild 9...b5. They have each been allocated a game.

Theoretical?

The main line of the Four Pawns Attack is extremely theoretical. This is the case in nearly all sharp variations as the slightest slip can cost the game. With 9...Bg4 Black might be able to reduce the workload a little but if you want to play 9...Re8 then you should be prepared to burn the midnight oil.

Statistics

In just over 2000 games from the diagram position White has scored 56%. White has scored 69% against 9...b5 when he plays 10 e5. After 9...Re8 White has scored 60% but only 48% against 9...Bg4. It looks like solid is best in the Four Pawns Attack.

Illustrative Games

Game 47

□ Banikas ■ Gallagher

French League 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f4 0-0 6 Nf3 c5 7 d5 e6 8 Be2

exd5 9 cxd5 Bg4

This is Black's most solid and reliable way of meeting the main line of the Four Pawns Attack. The idea behind 9...Bg4 is to exchange the bishop for the knight on f3. Without the knight White will find it difficult to play e4-e5. There is another reason why Black should exchange a pair of minor pieces. He has less space than White and, therefore, will find it difficult to accommodate a full set of pieces.



TIP: With less space it is usually a good idea to exchange pieces. This reduces the importance of a space advantage as your pieces will no longer have to battle each other for precious squares. In this particular example Black will no longer have to worry about whether to put his knight or bishop on d7.

10 0-0

Black's last move did not actually prevent White from playing 10 e5 – it just rendered it harmless. The position after 10 e5 dxe5 11 fxe5 Nfd7 12 e6 Bxf3! 13 Bxf3 Ne5 is thought to be about level.

10...Nbd7 11 Re1

11 h3 Bxf3 12 Bxf3 Re8 13 Re1 just transposes. White does have the option of the ultra-aggressive 13 g4 but this is very risky. Black should reply 13...h6 and meet 14 h4 with ...h5!.

11...Re8 12 h3 Bxf3 13 Bxf3 (Diagram 3)

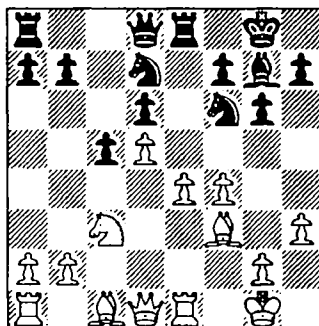


Diagram 3

A typical centre vs queenside situation

The most important factor in the position is the unbalanced pawn structure. White has a 2-1 majority in the centre whilst Black has 3-2 in his favour on the queenside. Pawn majorities need to be pushed so White will be looking to play e4-e5 and Black to expand on the queenside. Normally it is an advantage to have an extra central pawn but here this is counter-balanced by the fact that it is easier for Black to advance his majority.

13...Qa5!